Project 4 | charity: water Game Concept

The marketing team at charity: water wants you to mockup a game inspired by their global mission, with the goal of raising awareness among young people.

For your first deliverable, choose from the provided ideas, or come up with a game concept of your own. Then, break down what the game would look like on the screen. Plan core elements like layout, interaction, and feedback. Finally, you'll submit a wireframe or mockup of the game you intend to build.

Step 1: Choose Your Game Idea

Your goal is to decide on a game that would be fun, engaging, and doable for you to build over the next couple weeks. Choose something you'd enjoy working on, and that you would be excited to share in your portfolio later on!

Here are some ideas to get you started (feel free to go with those!) —

- **Water Quest:** A fast-paced, whack-a-mole-style game where players tap charity: water's signature yellow jerry cans to earn points. Include a score counter, feedback messages, milestones, and optional obstacles to make it more engaging.
- **Water Drop:** In this game, users collect as many falling water drops as possible while avoiding pollutants (bad drops). Users tap to collect drops before they hit the ground. Include a score counter, feedback messages, and penalties for "bad drops" to make it more engaging.

Don't like these ideas? Use AI tools to help you brainstorm a game concept, or build on the provided examples. Here's a prompt suggestion:

Try this prompt

I'm designing a simple web app game to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). The goal is specifically to engage college students. My goal is to create something fun, **[add any specific game elements you'd like]**. It also needs to be simple enough for me to build using HTML, CSS and JS **[add any additional skills or languages]**, with my current skills **[describe skill level]** and in **[add desired time to spend]**. Help me come up with ideas. For each idea, explain the game mechanics and break down what I would need to build.

Remember, brainstorming with AI is a conversation. Be discerning about the results, and don't be afraid to ask follow up questions or correct the AI if what it is suggesting sounds too complicated.

Step 2: Wireframe Your Game

Create a visual wireframe of your game, using hand-drawing or sketching software. Your wireframe should show the key features of your game.

Think about what the player sees: title, score, buttons, progress bars, icons, or avatars. Include all elements, including those as users we take for granted, such as a 'start' button or a feedback message telling the user the game ended. These provide a roadmap for everything you would need to code later.

- **Ready for a LevelUp? (20pts extra credit)**
    - **Use a Wireframing Tool (10pts):** Try out a wireframing tool like Figma, Balsamiq, or Adobe XD (or similar) to wireframe like a pro. Many of these tools offer a free limited-time demo.

- **Wireframe For Different Devices (10pts):** Think of your game being played on mobile screens and laptops. Create wireframes for each to show how screen size will impact the layout and gameplay.

Step 3: Plan the Game Logic

Using the template provided below, write up a short explanation of how the game logic works. Ask yourself: What actions does the player take? What gets updated—score, timer, achievements? What feedback does the player get (e.g., animations, visual cues, milestone unlocks)?

Word of advice: Keep it simple — you will have opportunities to iterate and expand your game later, but done is better than perfect, and you have a deadline! Your initial goal is to get started with something that you can do.

Use AI to verify that your game logic makes sense. Here's a sample prompt:

Try this prompt

Attached is my wireframe of a web game designed to promote charity: water's mission of providing clean water for all (see: charitywater.org). My game logic includes: **[insert description]**. Does this make sense? Identify any weaknesses in my game logic or opportunities for improvement.

As your understanding of the game logic deepens, return to step 2 and adjust your wireframe, removing unnecessary elements and adding new ones.

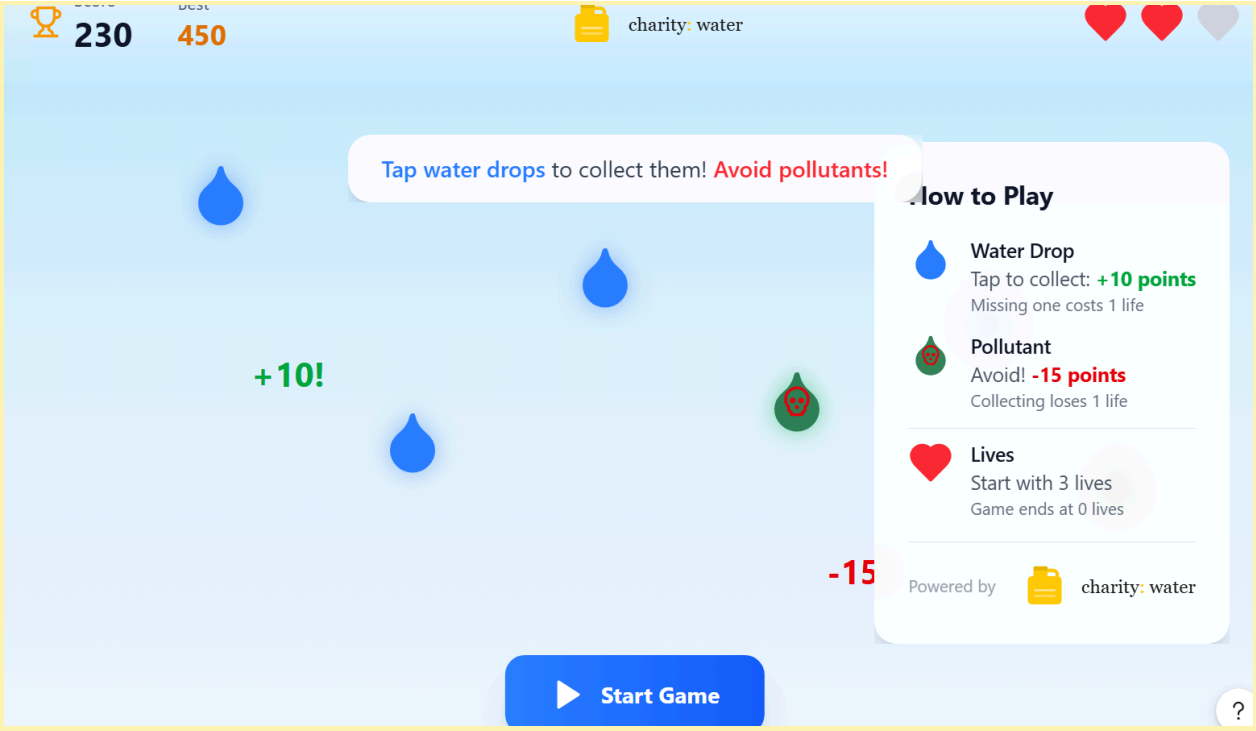
Step 4: Add Branding

When designing a game for an organization looking to increase awareness, it's important to build the brand's assets into the design. Refine your initial sketch by adding colors, icons, and styles that align with **charity: water's brand guidelines**. If you're keeping your wireframe minimal, include notes on where the brand's colors, images, links, or icons will be incorporated.

Step 5: Submit Your Work

Happy with your wireframe or mockup? Capture a clear, high-quality image of your game idea, and complete the following in order to submit your work.

1. Let's see it! Include your game wireframe image here: **(30pt)**



1B. Did you do any of the LevelUps? To help the evaluator notice—and give you the bonus points you deserve!—, please list them here:

I did the first levelup and used figma to create my sketch.

2. Fill in the template provided below and paste in a full description of the game logic (how the game works, what users do, what happens when they do it, etc). This description should be written in a no-frills style, as if breaking down the logic that needs to be coded into the game for an engineering team. **(30pt)**

(Write your own game logic below, following the template format 👇)

Water drop rescue - Game Logic:

1. Game Start:
  - What happens when the game first loads or starts? When the game loads, the player sees:

- Score counter
- Best score tracker
- 3 lives (heart icons)
- Instructions banner ("Tap water drops to collect them! Avoid pollutants!")
- Start Game button

No drops fall until the player presses **Start Game**

2. Player Actions:
  - What can the player click, tap, move, or do? Player taps falling objects.

There are two types:

Water Drops

- Player taps to collect
- Earns **+10 points**

- Missing a drop costs **1 life**

Pollutants

- Player should avoid tapping
- If tapped:
    - Player loses **15 points**
    - Player loses **1 life**

3. Game Logic:
  - What rules or conditions should the game check for? Objects fall randomly from the top of the screen.

- Each falling object is randomly generated as:
    - Clean water drop
    - Polluted drop
- The game constantly checks:
    - If an object is tapped
    - If an object hits the ground
    - If lives reach zero

4. Score/Feedback:

- Score updates in real time

Visual feedback:

- Collect water → **+10 appears in green**
- Tap pollutant → **-15 appears in red**
- Player loses life → heart disappears

The game also tracks:

- Current score
- Best score

5. Win or Lose Conditions:

The game ends when:

- Player loses all 3 lives
  OR
- Time limit ends (if timer is used)

End screen message appears based on performance:

- High score → positive encouragement
- Low score → "Try again" style message

6. Reset/Replay:

Player clicks **Start Game** again

Game resets:

- Score → 0
- Lives → 3
- Falling objects restart
- New session begins

3. Write up a note for your charity: water stakeholders describing your game idea. Imagine this as the body of the email that you send along with your wireframe image. Here, your writing can focus less on the nitty-gritty details, and more on the exciting elements of the game and why you believe users will love it. Highlight how and where charity: water brand assets (colors, images, link to website etc) will be incorporated. Your goal is to get them excited about your idea, and get stakeholder approval to continue building the game! **(10pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

Water Drop Rescue is an interactive tap-based game designed to help young audiences understand the importance of clean water access.

Players collect clean water drops while avoiding polluted ones, reinforcing the message that not all water sources are safe. The game creates urgency and emotional investment through a scoring system and life counter, making the impact of mistakes visible in real time.

The design incorporates charity: water's branding through:

- Clean blue tones representing safe water
- Yellow iconography and UI accents
- Simple, modern visuals that appeal to college-aged users

By turning the issue of water safety into a fast-paced challenge, the game encourages awareness through experience rather than passive learning.

4. Reflect on the experience of wireframing and planning a game. What surprised you? How did you use AI to assist you? What did you learn from this experience? What would you do differently next time? **(10 pt)**

(Paste or write your answer below 👇)

Wireframing the game helped me realize how many elements go into even a simple interactive experience, such as score tracking, lives, and feedback systems. Using AI helped me refine the game idea into something achievable within my technical skill level using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.

What surprised me most was how important visual feedback is for player understanding and engagement. Seeing how the score changes and lives decrease makes the experience feel more meaningful.

I learned that planning the layout before coding makes development clearer and prevents unnecessary complexity. Next time, I would experiment with multiple wireframe variations earlier before finalizing a design.

— Save and submit your work!

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